gateTunnelConnection HTTP/TLS/JSON

Interface Design Description

Service ID: *"gateTunnelConnection"*

Abstract
This document describes the HTTP/1.1 protocol with TLS payload security and JSON payload encoding variant of the `gateTunnelConnection` service of the GateTunnel system.

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1 Overview

This document describes the `gateTunnelConnection` service interface of the GateTunnel system, which provides relay sessions between the local cloud and a neighbour cloud: provider and consumer sessions opened by the Gatekeeper, and the legacy control sessions.

It's implemented using protocol, encoding as stated in below table:

Profile type	Type	Version
Transfer protocol	HTTP	1.1 [1]
Data encryption	TLS	1.3 [2], 1.2 [3]
Encoding	JSON	RFC 8259 [4]
Compression	N/A	-
Semantics	N/A	-
Ontology	N/A	-

Table 1: Communication and semantics details used for the `gateTunnelConnection` service interface

This document provides the Interface Design Description IDD to the *gateTunnelConnection – Service Description* document [5]. For further details about how this service is meant to be used, please consult that document.

The rest of this document describes how to realize the `gateTunnelConnection` service interface in detail. Both in terms of its operations (Section 2) and its information model (Section 3).

1.1 Interface registration

The service is registered in the ServiceRegistry with the interface template `generic_https`, policy `CERT_AUTH`, access address `gatetunnel`, port 8453 and base path `/gatetunnel`. The `operations` property of the interface lists the operations below with their method and path relative to the base path (path parameters are placeholders such as `{id}` that the consumer fills in):

Operation	Method	Path
`connect-provider`	POST	`/connect_provider`
`connect-consumer`	POST	`/connect_consumer`
`close-sessions`	POST	`/close_sessions`
`open-provider-session`	POST	`/intercloud/provider`
`open-consumer-session`	POST	`/intercloud/consumer`

2 Service Operations

The interfaces of the `gateTunnelConnection` service, its operations, data models and implementation are provided below. In particular, each subsection first names the HTTP method and path used to call the operation, after which it names the abstract operation from the `gateTunnelConnection` SD document, as well as input and output types.

Every request needs mutual TLS with a system or operator certificate of the cloud and `Authorization: Bearer IDENTITY-TOKEN//<token>`; the token is verified with Authentication and must belong to the system named by the certificate. Request and response bodies are `application/json` unless stated otherwise. Errors are answered with `{"error": "<text>"}` and the status codes `400 Bad Request` (invalid input), `401 Unauthorized` (no valid identity), `403 Forbidden` (caller not permitted), `404 Not Found`, `500 Internal Server Error`, `502 Bad Gateway` (a system it depends on failed) and `503 Service Unavailable` (overloaded).

2.1 POST /gatetunnel/connect_provider

Operation: connect-provider
Input: ControlSessionRequest
Output: ControlSessionResult

Creates a legacy control session for a provider (v4 API).

A successful call returns `201 Created` with the output in the body.

```
POST /gatetunnel/connect_provider HTTP/1.1
Host: gatetunnel:8453
Authorization: Bearer IDENTITY-TOKEN//<token>
Content-Type: application/json

{
  "providerCloud": "GoCloud|Company",
  "serviceDefinition": "temperatureReading",
  "queueId": "gatetunnel.7f3c2a10",
  "peerName": "GateTunnel-7f3c2a10"
}
```

Listing 1: An connect-provider invocation.

```
{
  "sessionId": "7f3c2a10",
  "queueId": "gatetunnel.7f3c2a10",
  "peerName": "GateTunnel-7f3c2a10",
  "serverPort": 8000,
  "state": "PROVIDER_READY"
}
```

Listing 2: An connect-provider response.

2.2 POST /gatetunnel/connect_consumer

Operation: connect-consumer
Input: ConnectConsumerRequest
Output: ControlSessionResult

Connects a consumer to a legacy control session.

A successful call returns `201 Created` with the output in the body.

```
POST /gatetunnel/connect_consumer HTTP/1.1
Host: gatetunnel:8453
```

```
Authorization: Bearer IDENTITY-TOKEN//<token>
Content-Type: application/json

{
  "queueId": "gatetunnel.7f3c2a10"
}
```

Listing 3: An connect-consumer invocation.

```
{
  "sessionId": "7f3c2a10",
  "queueId": "gatetunnel.7f3c2a10",
  "peerName": "GateTunnel-7f3c2a10",
  "serverPort": 8000,
  "state": "PROVIDER_READY"
}
```

Listing 4: An connect-consumer response.

2.3 POST /gatetunnel/close_sessions

Operation: close-sessions
Input: ClosePortsRequest
Output: Array<Object>

Closes legacy control sessions by port; returns the ports that failed.
A successful call returns `200 OK` with the output in the body.

```
POST /gatetunnel/close_sessions HTTP/1.1
Host: gatetunnel:8453
Authorization: Bearer IDENTITY-TOKEN//<token>
Content-Type: application/json

{
  "ports": [
    8080
  ]
}
```

Listing 5: An close-sessions invocation.

```
[
  {}
]
```

Listing 6: An close-sessions response.

2.4 POST /gatetunnel/intercloud/provider

Operation: open-provider-session
Input: ProviderSessionRequest
Output: SessionEndpoint

Gatekeeper only: opens a relay session towards a local provider for a negotiated foreign consumer.
A successful call returns `201 Created` with the output in the body.

```
POST /gatetunnel/intercloud/provider HTTP/1.1
Host: gatetunnel:8453
Authorization: Bearer IDENTITY-TOKEN//<token>
```

```
Content-Type: application/json

{
  "sessionId": "7f3c2a10",
  "consumer": "TemperatureDisplay",
  "consumerCloud": "LOCAL",
  "provider": "TemperatureSensor",
  "serviceDefinition": "temperatureReading",
  "peer": "GateTunnel.GoCloud.Company.arrowhead.eu",
  "target": 21.5
}
```

Listing 7: An open-provider-session invocation.

```
{
  "address": "gatetunnel",
  "port": 8201,
  "sessionId": "7f3c2a10"
}
```

Listing 8: An open-provider-session response.

2.5 POST /gatetunnel/intercloud/consumer

Operation: open-consumer-session
Input: ConsumerSessionRequest
Output: SessionEndpoint

Gatekeeper only: opens a local listener that forwards a local consumer's requests to the provider cloud. A successful call returns `201 Created` with the output in the body.

```
POST /gatetunnel/intercloud/consumer HTTP/1.1
Host: gatetunnel:8453
Authorization: Bearer IDENTITY-TOKEN//<token>
Content-Type: application/json

{
  "sessionId": "7f3c2a10",
  "consumer": "TemperatureDisplay",
  "providerCloud": "GoCloud|Company",
  "provider": "TemperatureSensor",
  "serviceDefinition": "temperatureReading",
  "peer": "GateTunnel.GoCloud.Company.arrowhead.eu"
}
```

Listing 9: An open-consumer-session invocation.

```
{
  "address": "gatetunnel",
  "port": 8201,
  "sessionId": "7f3c2a10"
}
```

Listing 10: An open-consumer-session response.

3 Data Models

Here, all data objects that can be part of the service calls associated with this service are listed in alphabetic order. Note that each subsection, which describes one type of object, begins with the *struct* keyword, which is meant to denote a JSON Object that must contain certain fields, or names, with values conforming to explicitly named types. Fields that are not needed may be omitted or `null` in requests; empty fields are omitted in responses. As a complement to the primary types defined in this section, there is also a list of secondary types in Section 3.8, which are used to represent things like hashes, identifiers and texts.

3.1 struct ClosePortsRequest

Object Field	Value Type	Description
"ports"	Array<Number>	Control ports to close (a bare JSON array is also accepted).

3.2 struct ConnectConsumerRequest

Object Field	Value Type	Description
"queueId"	String	Relay queue of the provider session.

3.3 struct ConsumerSessionRequest

Object Field	Value Type	Description
"sessionId"	String	Session identifier from the provider cloud.
"consumer"	String	Consumer system.
"providerCloud"	String	Provider cloud.
"provider"	String	Provider system.
"serviceDefinition"	String	Service definition.
"peer"	String	Peer GateTunnel common name.

3.4 struct ControlSessionRequest

Object Field	Value Type	Description
"consumer"	Object	Consumer system descriptor.
"provider"	Object	Provider system descriptor.
"consumerCloud"	Object	Consumer cloud.
"providerCloud"	Object	Provider cloud.
"relay"	Object	Relay descriptor.
"serviceDefinition"	String	Service definition.
"queueId"	String	Relay queue; generated if absent.
"peerName"	String	Peer name; generated if absent.

3.5 struct ControlSessionResult

Object Field	Value Type	Description
"sessionId"	String	Session identifier.
"queueId"	String	Relay queue.
"peerName"	String	Peer name.
"serverPort"	Number	Local control port.
"state"	String	Session state.

3.6 struct ProviderSessionRequest

Object Field	Value Type	Description
"sessionId"	String	Session identifier.
"consumer"	String	Consumer system.
"consumerCloud"	String	Consumer cloud, must match the peer certificate.
"provider"	String	Provider system.
"serviceDefinition"	String	Service definition.
"peer"	String	Peer GateTunnel common name.
"target"	Object	Provider endpoint: `address`, `port`, `basePath` and the negotiated `operations`.

3.7 struct SessionEndpoint

Object Field	Value Type	Description
"address"	String	Advertised address of the local session listener.
"port"	Number	Port of the session listener.
"sessionId"	String	Session identifier.

3.8 Primitives

As all messages are encoded using the JSON format [4], the following primitive constructs, part of that standard, become available. Note that the official standard is defined in terms of parsing rules, while this list only concerns syntactic information. Furthermore, the Object and Array types are given optional generic type parameters, which are used in this document to signify when pair values or elements are expected to conform to certain types.

Type	Description
Array	A JSON Array [4]; Array<A> has elements of type A.
Number	JSON Number, an integer.
Object	JSON Object; Object<A> has string keys and values of type A.
String	JSON String.

4 References

[1] R. Fielding, M. Nottingham, and J. Reschke, “Http/1.1,” IETF, RFC 9112, 2022.

[2] E. Rescorla, “The transport layer security (tls) protocol version 1.3,” IETF, RFC 8446, 2018.

[3] T. Dierks and E. Rescorla, “The transport layer security (tls) protocol version 1.2,” IETF, RFC 5246, 2008.

[4] T. Bray, “The javascript object notation (json) data interchange format,” IETF, RFC 8259, 2017.

[5] J. Delsing, “gateTunnelConnection – Service Description (GateTunnel),” Eclipse Arrowhead, SD 5.2.2, 2026, gateTunnel-v5.2.2-gateTunnelConnection-SD.pdf.

5 Revision History

5.1 Amendments

No.	Date	Version	Subject of Amendments	Author
1	2026-10-22	5.2.2	Document created from the Arrowhead LaTeX templates for the 5.2.2 Java Spring implementation, including the local extensions of this workspace.	Jerker Delsing
2	2026-10-30	5.2.2	Checked against the primary Java source tree (Eclipse-Arrowhead-java): services, operations, paths and data models unchanged.	Claude Opus 5.5 (draft)

5.2 Quality Assurance

No.	Date	Version	Approved by
1		5.2.2	